



Manager Joe Hauser of the Duluth-Superior White Sox has been in spring training for more than a week with a bunch of young fellows, but as of today he hasn't the slightest idea which of them will be assigned to him for the Northern league race.

What's more, he probably won't know until three or four days before camp closes next week.

That gives little or no time to play exhibition games, and means weaknesses cannot be detected until the Twisox get into actual competition.

Any coach or manager knows that a team, no matter what its talent might be, needs time to work together to get good results.

For this reason we can't understand the thinking behind the camp procedure followed by the Chicago White Sox in Hollywood, Fla.

Perhaps there are advantages as far as conditioning is concerned, and teaching, since there are experts for all departments of the game—pitching, infield, batting, catching, etc., but we doubt it.

More important, we think, is the unity and spirit that is welded when a club takes shape early in the training period and the competition that results when there is a fight for places on the team.

Frankly, we like the Cardinal farm program much better.

A manager, from the very outset, is assigned a roster from which to mold his team, and he works it as a unit day in and day out. There are numerous exhibition games, almost every day in fact, in which problems can be detected and corrected.

If it becomes apparent a second baseman, for example, isn't going to make the grade, a replacement is found immediately and that problem is licked.

After a couple of three weeks of experimenting a manager has what he thinks is the best team available from the talent at hand, and by the time he is ready to open the season the kids themselves know what they can do.

Not so under the Chisox system. The trial and error period doesn't start until the team is in league competition, and that can be disastrous.

This idea of games not being important early in the season because there is a long time to catch up, is a lot of bunk. A win on opening day is just as important as the one that is needed to clinch the pennant.

We have a suspicion that until the White Sox change their spring training procedure its minor league teams, particularly in the lower classifications, are doomed to slow starts unless they're blessed with an unusual amount of luck.